

Standard Operating Procedure

Inbound Receiving, Verification and Putaway

Bhiwandi Distribution Centre — Unit II

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1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure establishes the mandatory method by which inbound consignments are received, verified, recorded and put away at Northbridge Logistics Limited warehouses. Its objective is to ensure that every unit of stock taken into custody is counted, inspected, recorded in the warehouse management system and placed in a known storage location before it is made available for outbound allocation.

Inbound receiving is the control point at which liability for stock transfers from the consignor or the transporter to Northbridge. Errors introduced at this stage propagate into every downstream activity — cycle counting, order picking, customer billing and annual stock audit. A quantity accepted incorrectly at the dock cannot be corrected by any subsequent warehouse process without a formal inventory adjustment.

This procedure therefore serves three purposes simultaneously. It protects the customer against stock loss, it protects Northbridge against unsubstantiated shortage claims, and it produces the documentary evidence required under the terms of the master service agreement held with each contract logistics customer.

2. Scope

2.1 Activities covered

This procedure applies from the point at which an advance shipping notice is received from the consignor until the point at which stock is confirmed into a storage bin and the goods receipt note is posted in FleetLink. It covers ambient, temperature-controlled and hazardous consignments arriving by road at any Northbridge-operated facility.

- Inbound consignments against a purchase order or stock transfer note.
- Customer-owned stock received under a bonded or free-trade warehousing arrangement.
- Sales returns and reverse consignments received through the returns dock.
- Inter-warehouse transfers between Northbridge facilities.
- Packaging material, pallets and returnable transit equipment received on gate pass.

2.2 Activities not covered

- Outbound picking, packing and dispatch, governed by NBL/SOP/WH/021.
- Cycle counting and perpetual inventory verification, governed by NBL/SOP/WH/033.
- Customs clearance for import consignments, governed by NBL/SOP/FF/008.
- Vehicle placement, freight negotiation and transporter settlement, governed by NBL/SOP/TR/002.
- Physical destruction of expired or condemned stock, governed by NBL/SOP/QA/019.

2.3 Sites in scope

As at the effective date of this revision, this procedure is in force at the facilities listed below. Facilities commissioned after the effective date adopt this procedure from the date of their operational readiness sign-off.

Facility code	Location	Area (sq ft)	Inbound docks	Temperature-controlled
BHW-01	Bhiwandi, Maharashtra – Unit I	412,000	8	No
BHW-02	Bhiwandi, Maharashtra – Unit II	586,000	6	Yes – 2 to 8 °C

Facility code	Location	Area (sq ft)	Inbound docks	Temperature-controlled
CHK-01	Chakan, Pune, Maharashtra	298,000	5	No
HSR-01	Hosur, Tamil Nadu	341,000	6	Yes – 15 to 25 °C
GGN-02	Gurugram, Haryana	265,000	4	No
LKO-01	Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh	188,000	3	No

3. Definitions and Abbreviations

Term	Definition
ASN	Advance Shipping Notice. Electronic notification from the consignor listing the material, quantity and expected arrival window of a consignment.
GRN	Goods Receipt Note. The system document generated on acceptance of a consignment, constituting Northbridge's acknowledgement of custody.
Putaway	The movement of received stock from the staging area to its designated storage bin, together with system confirmation of that bin.
SKU	Stock Keeping Unit. The lowest level at which a distinct item is tracked.
Bin	A uniquely addressed storage location within the warehouse, expressed in the convention described in Annexure 4.
Shortage	A received quantity lower than the quantity declared on the invoice or delivery challan.
Overage	A received quantity higher than the quantity declared on the invoice or delivery challan.
Quarantine	A physically segregated and system-blocked status applied to stock pending quality disposition.
RTE	Returnable Transit Equipment. Pallets, crates, roll cages and dollies belonging to Northbridge or the customer.
Cold chain breach	Any recorded excursion outside the validated temperature range for the duration and magnitude defined in Section 16.
Deviation	Any departure from this procedure, whether planned or unplanned, requiring recording under Section 25.
MSA	Master Service Agreement. The contract governing the commercial and service terms applicable to a customer.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Accountability for each activity rests with a single named role. Where a role is vacant or the incumbent is absent, the responsibility escalates to the role shown in the reporting line, and the substitution is recorded in the shift handover log.

Role	Primary responsibilities	Accountable to
Security Officer	Gate entry recording, vehicle seal verification, driver identification, initial document sighting, weighbridge capture.	Executive – Inbound
Material Handler	Physical unloading, pallet formation, staging to the allocated bay, physical transport to bin location.	Supervisor – Inbound
Inbound Executive	Quantity verification, document matching, GRN posting, discrepancy raising, bin assignment.	Supervisor – Inbound
Supervisor – Inbound	Dock allocation, shift resourcing, discrepancy review, putaway confirmation audit, shift handover.	Warehouse Manager

Role	Primary responsibilities	Accountable to
Quality Inspector	Sampling, visual and documentary inspection, quarantine application and release, cold chain data review.	Manager – Quality Assurance
Warehouse Manager	Daily inbound performance review, deviation approval up to the limits in Section 25, customer communication.	Head – Warehouse Operations
Manager – Quality Assurance	Disposition of quarantined stock, cold chain breach determination, audit of this procedure.	Head – Quality Assurance
Head – Warehouse Operations	Procedure ownership, revision approval, cross-facility consistency.	Chief Operating Officer

5. Reference Documents

Reference	Title
NBL/SOP/WH/021	Outbound Order Picking, Packing and Dispatch
NBL/SOP/WH/033	Cycle Counting and Perpetual Inventory Verification
NBL/SOP/QA/011	Sampling and Acceptance Inspection
NBL/SOP/QA/019	Disposal of Expired, Damaged and Condemned Stock
NBL/SOP/HS/004	Material Handling Equipment Operation and Pre-Use Inspection
NBL/SOP/HS/007	Storage and Handling of Hazardous Substances
NBL/SOP/TR/002	Vehicle Placement and Transporter Settlement
NBL/SOP/FF/008	Customs Clearance for Import Consignments
NBL/POL/IT/003	Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy
FleetLink User Manual v4.2	Transport and Warehouse Management System — Sections 11 and 12 describe the inbound receipt and exception screens referenced throughout this procedure.
Legal Metrology Act, 2009	Statutory requirements for weighing and measuring instruments used in trade.
Factories Act, 1948	Statutory obligations relating to working conditions and material handling safety.

6. Process Overview

The inbound process comprises seven sequential stages. Each stage has a defined entry condition, a defined output and a defined record. No stage may be started before the output of the preceding stage has been produced, other than under a recorded deviation.

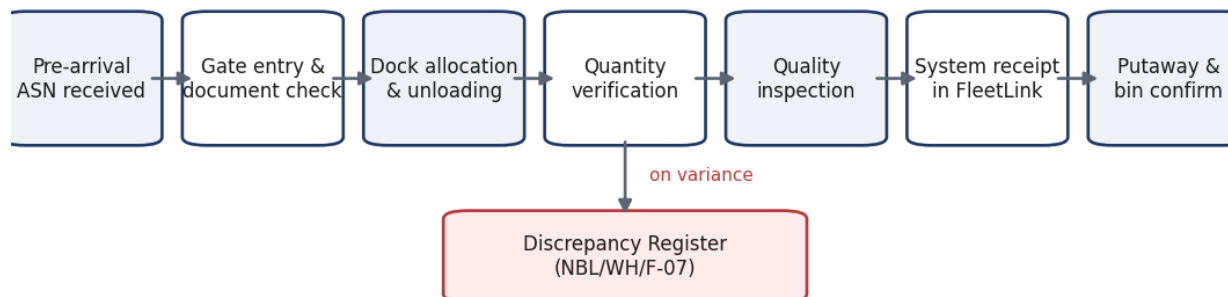


Figure 1: Inbound receiving process flow, showing the seven mandatory stages and the point at which a variance diverts the consignment to the discrepancy register.

Stage	Entry condition	Output	Record	Target cycle time
Pre-arrival planning	ASN received in FleetLink	Dock and resource plan	Inbound plan report	≥ 4 hours before arrival
Gate entry	Vehicle reports at gate	Gate entry number allotted	Gate register / FleetLink	15 minutes
Unloading	Dock allocated, seal verified	Stock in staging bay	Unloading tally sheet	Per Section 9.4
Quantity verification	Unloading complete	Verified quantity per SKU	Tally sheet, countersigned	45 minutes
Quality inspection	Quantity verified	Accept, reject or quarantine	Inspection report	2 hours
System receipt	Inspection disposition recorded	GRN posted	GRN in FleetLink	30 minutes
Putaway	GRN posted, bin assigned	Stock in bin, system confirmed	Putaway confirmation	4 hours from GRN

The cumulative target from gate entry to putaway confirmation is eight working hours for ambient consignments and six working hours for temperature-controlled consignments. Performance against these targets is measured as set out in Section 21.

7. Pre-Arrival Planning

7.1 Advance shipping notice

Consignors are contractually required to transmit an ASN not less than four hours before the planned arrival of a vehicle. The ASN is received into FleetLink through the customer integration channel and appears on the Expected Receipts screen. Where a customer is not integrated, the ASN is received by email and entered manually by the Inbound Executive.

The Inbound Executive verifies that each ASN carries the following minimum data before accepting it into the inbound plan. An ASN failing this check is returned to the consignor and the vehicle is not scheduled.

1. Consignor name and customer code as registered in FleetLink.
2. Purchase order or stock transfer note reference.
3. SKU code, description and declared quantity for every line.
4. Batch number and expiry date for every batch-controlled SKU.
5. Declared gross and net weight.
6. Vehicle registration number and expected arrival window.
7. Temperature class and, for cold chain, the validated transport range.
8. Hazard classification and UN number where applicable.

7.2 Dock and resource allocation

The Supervisor – Inbound prepares the dock allocation plan for the following shift before the end of the current shift. Allocation considers the temperature class of the consignment, the availability of the appropriate staging bay, the material handling equipment required and the number of handlers rostered.

Consignment type	Permitted docks (BHW-02)	Staging bay	Minimum handlers	MHE required
Ambient palletised	D1 to D4	Bay A	2	Electric pallet truck
Ambient loose / floor loaded	D1 to D3	Bay A	4	Hand pallet truck, conveyor
Temperature-controlled 2–8 °C	D5, D6 only	Cold dock	3	Insulated pallet cover, PET
Hazardous – Class 3 or 9	D6 only	Hazmat staging	3	Spill kit, non-sparking MHE
Returns / reverse	D4	Bay B	2	Hand pallet truck
RTE / packaging	D1	RTE yard	1	Hand pallet truck

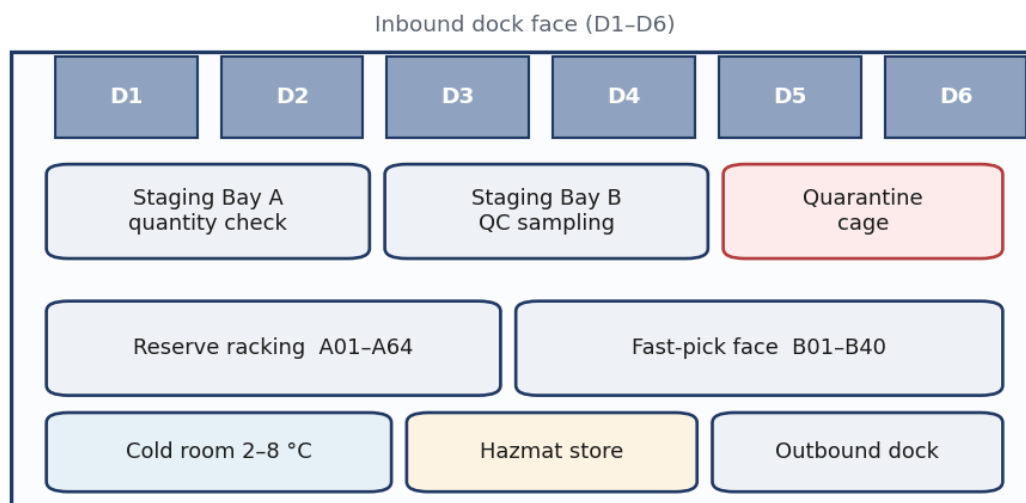


Figure 2: Indicative dock and staging layout at Bhiwandi Unit II. Docks D5 and D6 are the only docks fitted with dock shelters and are therefore the only docks permitted for temperature-controlled receipt.

8. Gate Entry and Document Verification

8.1 Sequence at the gate

1. The Security Officer stops the vehicle at the outer barrier and confirms the vehicle registration number against the inbound plan. A vehicle not appearing on the plan is held in the waiting bay and the Supervisor – Inbound is informed.
2. The driver presents the delivery challan, tax invoice, e-way bill and, where applicable, the lorry receipt and temperature data logger.
3. The Security Officer records the driver name, licence number and mobile number, and verifies photographic identity.
4. The seal number on the vehicle is compared with the seal number declared on the lorry receipt. A mismatch, or an absent or tampered seal, is treated under Section 8.3.
5. The vehicle proceeds to the weighbridge where the gross inward weight is captured.
6. A gate entry number is generated in FleetLink and written on the delivery challan.
7. The vehicle is directed to the allocated dock.

8.2 Documents required

Document	Mandatory	Verified against	Retained
Tax invoice	Yes	ASN, purchase order	Yes – 8 years
Delivery challan	Yes	Tax invoice	Yes – 8 years
E-way bill	Yes above threshold value	Invoice value, vehicle number	Yes – 8 years
Lorry receipt	Yes for transporter-moved cargo	Seal number, vehicle number	Yes – 3 years
Temperature data logger report	Yes for cold chain	Validated range in ASN	Yes – 5 years
Material safety data sheet	Yes for hazardous cargo	UN number, hazard class	Yes – current version
Batch certificate of analysis	Where specified in the MSA	Batch number on carton	Yes – 5 years
Weighbridge slip	Yes where weighment applies	Declared gross weight	Yes – 3 years

8.3 Seal discrepancy

A seal discrepancy is a potential loss event and is escalated immediately. The vehicle is not unloaded until the escalation has been closed. The Security Officer photographs the seal and the vehicle, records the observation in the gate register, and informs the Supervisor – Inbound, who informs the Warehouse Manager within fifteen minutes.

Unloading may proceed only on the written authorisation of the Warehouse Manager, and only under continuous supervision with a hundred per cent count of every carton. The authorisation and the count result are attached to the discrepancy register entry.

9. Dock Allocation and Unloading

9.1 Pre-unloading checks

Before the vehicle is opened, the Material Handler and the Inbound Executive jointly confirm the conditions in Annexure 1. Any condition failing the check is recorded and the Supervisor – Inbound decides whether to proceed, hold or reject the vehicle.

- The dock leveller is engaged and the wheel chock is in position.
- The vehicle engine is switched off and the ignition key is surrendered to the Security Officer.
- The dock area is clear of obstruction and adequately lit to not less than 150 lux.
- For cold chain, the dock shelter is sealed against the vehicle body before the doors are opened.
- Material handling equipment has passed its pre-use inspection under NBL/SOP/HS/004.

9.2 Unloading method

Palletised consignments are unloaded pallet by pallet using an electric pallet truck. Floor-loaded consignments are unloaded carton by carton onto pallets formed at the dock, with the tally recorded on the unloading tally sheet as each pallet is completed. Cartons are not stacked above the height marked on the carton, and in no case above five tiers for corrugated cartons.

9.3 Tally recording

The unloading tally is recorded by the Inbound Executive in ink on the unloading tally sheet. Corrections are made by striking through the original entry, writing the corrected value alongside and initialling. Correction fluid and overwriting are not permitted. The completed tally sheet is signed by the Inbound Executive and countersigned by the driver.

9.4 Unloading time standards

Consignment profile	Vehicle type	Standard unloading time	Detention starts after
Palletised, uniform SKU	32 ft container	60 minutes	90 minutes
Palletised, mixed SKU	32 ft container	90 minutes	120 minutes
Floor loaded, uniform SKU	32 ft container	150 minutes	210 minutes
Floor loaded, mixed SKU	32 ft container	210 minutes	300 minutes
Palletised	20 ft / LCV	45 minutes	75 minutes
Cold chain, palletised	Reefer 20 ft	45 minutes	60 minutes

Detention charges accrue to the transporter and are recorded against the trip in FleetLink so that they are captured in the transporter settlement run described in NBL/SOP/TR/002. Detention arising from a Northbridge-caused delay, such as unavailability of a dock or of handlers, is recorded as a facility delay and is not charged.

10. Quantity Verification

10.1 Verification basis

Received quantity is verified against the declared quantity on the tax invoice, not against the ASN. Where the invoice and the ASN disagree, the invoice prevails for verification purposes and the difference is recorded as an ASN variance for customer follow-up.

10.2 Counting method

Consignment value band	Count method	Verified by	Second check
Up to ■ 5 lakh	Carton-level count, weight cross-check on one carton per SKU	Inbound Executive	Not required
■ 5 lakh to ■ 25 lakh	Carton-level count, unit count on 10 per cent of cartons per SKU	Inbound Executive	Supervisor countersign
Above ■ 25 lakh	Carton-level count, unit count on 100 per cent of cartons for high-value SKUs	Inbound Executive	Supervisor countersign and photograph
Any value, seal discrepancy	100 per cent unit count	Inbound Executive	Supervisor present throughout
Any value, prior shortage history	100 per cent unit count for the affected SKU	Inbound Executive	Supervisor countersign

High-value SKUs are those identified as such in the customer master in FleetLink. The designation is maintained by the Warehouse Manager on the instruction of the customer and is reviewed quarterly.

10.3 Batch and expiry capture

For every batch-controlled SKU the batch number and expiry date are read from the carton and captured into FleetLink at the time of receipt. Stock is not accepted where the remaining shelf life at the date of receipt is less than the minimum shelf life specified in the customer master. The default minimum, where the customer master is silent, is seventy-five per cent of total shelf life.

Product category	Minimum residual shelf life at receipt	Authority to relax
Pharmaceutical formulations	85 per cent of total shelf life	Customer written instruction only
Nutraceuticals and supplements	80 per cent	Customer written instruction only
Packaged food, ambient	75 per cent	Warehouse Manager
Personal care and cosmetics	70 per cent	Warehouse Manager
Consumer durables spare parts	Not applicable	Not applicable

11. Weighment

Weighment provides an independent check on the declared quantity and is mandatory for all consignments received at facilities fitted with a weighbridge. The gross inward weight is captured at gate entry and the tare weight is captured after unloading is complete. The difference is the net received weight.

A variance between the net received weight and the declared net weight of more than half of one per cent, or twenty-five kilograms, whichever is lower, is treated as a quantity discrepancy and is investigated under Section 14 before the GRN is posted.

Check	Tolerance	Action on breach
Net weight against declared net weight	0.5 per cent or 25 kg, whichever is lower	Investigate under Section 14

Check	Tolerance	Action on breach
Weighbridge calibration	Valid stamping certificate under the Legal Metrology Act	Suspend weighment, escalate to Warehouse Manager
Daily zero-error check	± 10 kg on an empty platform	Log in weighbridge register, call service provider
Monthly test weight verification	± 0.1 per cent on a 5 tonne test load	Withdraw weighbridge from use until corrected

The weighbridge register is maintained at the gate and is reviewed weekly by the Supervisor – Inbound. Calibration is carried out by an agency approved under the Legal Metrology Act and the certificate is retained for the life of the instrument plus three years.

12. Quality Inspection and Sampling

12.1 Inspection scope

Quality inspection at inbound is a receiving inspection, not a laboratory analysis. Its purpose is to detect visible non-conformity, packaging failure, documentary deficiency and evidence of transport abuse. Analytical testing, where the customer requires it, is carried out under NBL/SOP/QA/011 on samples drawn during this inspection.

12.2 Sampling plan

Sample size is determined from the lot size using the general inspection level II plan reproduced in Annexure 3. The acceptance quality limit applied is that specified in the customer master, defaulting to 1.0 for critical characteristics and 2.5 for major characteristics.

Lot size (cartons)	Sample size	Accept on (AQL 1.0)	Reject on (AQL 1.0)
2 to 8	2	0	1
9 to 15	3	0	1
16 to 25	5	0	1
26 to 50	8	0	1
51 to 90	13	0	1
91 to 150	20	0	1
151 to 280	32	1	2
281 to 500	50	1	2
501 to 1200	80	2	3
1201 to 3200	125	3	4
3201 and above	200	5	6

12.3 Characteristics inspected

Characteristic	Classification	Method	Non-conformity example
Carton integrity	Major	Visual, 100 per cent of outer cartons	Crushed corner, water staining, punctured face
Seal and tape integrity	Major	Visual on sampled cartons	Reopened carton, mismatched tape
Label legibility and content	Critical	Visual on sampled cartons	Missing batch, illegible expiry, wrong SKU
Batch and expiry match to document	Critical	Compare carton to invoice	Batch not listed on invoice
Unit count within carton	Major	Open and count sampled cartons	Short count inside sealed carton
Foreign odour or leakage	Critical	Sensory and visual	Solvent smell, visible liquid trace
Pest evidence	Critical	Visual on pallet and carton	Gnaw marks, droppings, live insects
Temperature indicator	Critical for cold chain	Read indicator on carton	Irreversible indicator triggered

12.4 Disposition

The Quality Inspector records one of three dispositions against every SKU and batch. The disposition is entered in FleetLink and drives the stock status applied at putaway.

Disposition	System status	Physical location	Onward action
Accept	Unrestricted	Storage bin	Available for allocation
Quarantine	Blocked – quality hold	Quarantine cage	Disposition within 3 working days by Manager – QA
Reject	Blocked – rejected	Quarantine cage, rejected zone	Return to consignor or destruction under NBL/SOP/QA/019

Stock in quarantine status cannot be allocated to an outbound order by FleetLink. The system block is released only by a user holding the Quality Disposition role, and every release is written to the audit trail with the user identity, timestamp and reason.

13. System Receipt in FleetLink

13.1 Posting the goods receipt note

The GRN is the system record of acceptance and is posted only after quantity verification and quality disposition are both complete. Posting a GRN before inspection is a critical non-compliance under Section 25.

The Inbound Executive opens the Inbound Receipt screen described in Section 11 of the FleetLink User Manual, selects the gate entry number, and enters the verified quantity and disposition for each line. The system compares the entered quantity against the invoice quantity and blocks posting where a variance exists and no discrepancy record has been raised.

13.2 Mandatory fields

Field	Source	Validation applied by FleetLink
Gate entry number	Gate register	Must exist and be open
Invoice number and date	Tax invoice	Must be unique per consignor
SKU code	Carton label	Must exist in the customer material master
Received quantity	Verified tally sheet	Must equal invoice quantity or be linked to a discrepancy record
Batch number	Carton label	Mandatory where the SKU is batch-controlled
Expiry date	Carton label	Must satisfy the residual shelf life rule in 10.3
Quality disposition	Inspection report	Mandatory; defaults to quarantine if blank
Storage bin	Bin allocation logic	Must be empty or hold the same SKU and batch
Net received weight	Weighbridge	Must be within the tolerance in Section 11

13.3 Label generation

On successful posting, FleetLink generates a pallet label for each pallet in the consignment. The label is affixed to the shorter face of the pallet at a height of between 1.2 and 1.5 metres so that it is scannable without a ladder. A pallet without a legible label is not accepted into a storage bin.

NORTHBRIDGE LOGISTICS BHIWANDI DC - INBOUND	
GRN No. GRN/BHW/25/104882 Received 14-Feb-2025 09:42	Bin A-14-03
 8 906 1148 82004 3	

Figure 3: Pallet label format generated by FleetLink on GRN posting. The barcode encodes the GRN number and the pallet sequence; the bin address is printed in plain text for visual confirmation at the rack face.

14. Discrepancy Identification and Handling

14.1 Categories

Code	Discrepancy	Raised by	Resolution owner	Target closure
D-01	Shortage against invoice	Inbound Executive	Warehouse Manager	2 working days
D-02	Overage against invoice	Inbound Executive	Warehouse Manager	2 working days
D-03	Wrong SKU received	Inbound Executive	Warehouse Manager	2 working days
D-04	Batch not on invoice	Inbound Executive	Manager – QA	1 working day
D-05	Damaged packaging	Quality Inspector	Manager – QA	3 working days
D-06	Insufficient residual shelf life	Quality Inspector	Manager – QA	1 working day
D-07	Cold chain excursion	Quality Inspector	Head – QA	Same day
D-08	Seal discrepancy	Security Officer	Warehouse Manager	Same day
D-09	Weight variance beyond tolerance	Inbound Executive	Warehouse Manager	2 working days
D-10	Document deficiency	Inbound Executive	Supervisor – Inbound	1 working day
D-11	Pest or contamination evidence	Quality Inspector	Head – QA	Same day
D-12	Unmanifested cargo	Inbound Executive	Warehouse Manager	Same day

14.2 Recording

Every discrepancy is recorded in the discrepancy register in the format at Annexure 2 and simultaneously in the Exception Management screen of FleetLink. Photographic evidence is mandatory for codes D-05, D-07, D-08, D-11 and D-12, and is attached to the FleetLink record before the driver is released.

The consignor is notified through FleetLink within four working hours of the discrepancy being raised. A discrepancy notified later than four hours is itself recorded as a process deviation under Section 25, because late notification weakens Northbridge's position in any subsequent claim.

14.3 Provisional receipt

Where a discrepancy affects part of a consignment only, the unaffected part is received in full and the affected part is held. This prevents an entire vehicle being blocked by a single line item. The held quantity is recorded in quarantine status against the discrepancy number and is not shown as available stock.

15. Putaway

15.1 Bin assignment

FleetLink assigns a storage bin at the point of GRN posting using the rules below, applied in order. Where no bin satisfying the rules is available, the system assigns an overflow bin and raises a capacity alert to the Supervisor – Inbound.

1. The bin must be within the temperature zone required by the SKU.
2. The bin must be empty, or must contain the same SKU and the same batch.
3. The bin must be within the velocity band matching the SKU's movement classification.
4. For a batch-controlled SKU, the bin must not place a later-expiring batch in front of an earlier-expiring batch on the same pick face.
5. The bin must have sufficient residual weight and cube capacity for the pallet.
6. Preference is given to the bin closest to the outbound dock within the applicable velocity band.

15.2 Velocity bands

Band	Criterion	Storage location	Target putaway distance
A – fast	Top 20 per cent of lines picked in the trailing 90 days	Fast-pick face, ground and first level	Under 30 metres from dock
B – medium	Next 30 per cent of lines picked	Reserve racking, levels 1 to 3	30 to 70 metres
C – slow	Remaining 50 per cent of lines picked	Reserve racking, levels 3 and above	Beyond 70 metres
D – dormant	No pick in the trailing 180 days	Deep reserve or mezzanine	Not applicable

Velocity bands are recalculated on the first working day of each month by the Warehouse Manager. Reslotting arising from a band change is executed under NBL/SOP/WH/033 and is not part of this procedure.

15.3 Confirmation

The Material Handler scans the pallet label and then scans the bin label. FleetLink accepts the confirmation only where the scanned bin matches the assigned bin, or where the handler holds the Bin Override role and records an override reason from the predefined list. Blind confirmation without scanning is not permitted under any circumstance.

Override reason	Permitted role	Follow-up required
Assigned bin physically blocked	Supervisor – Inbound	Housekeeping ticket raised
Assigned bin damaged	Supervisor – Inbound	Rack inspection request
Pallet dimension exceeds bin	Supervisor – Inbound	Master data correction
Bin label unreadable	Material Handler	Label reprint request
System bin allocation error	Warehouse Manager	IT incident logged in FleetLink

15.4 Putaway ageing

A pallet that has been received but not confirmed into a bin is described as ageing. Ageing stock is physically present but not reliably locatable, and is therefore treated as an operational risk rather than as available inventory.

Ageing bracket	Status	Action
Under 4 hours	Within target	None
4 to 8 hours	Alert	Supervisor – Inbound reassigns handler capacity
8 to 24 hours	Breach	Warehouse Manager records cause in the daily review
Beyond 24 hours	Critical breach	Head – Warehouse Operations informed; stock physically located and counted

16. Temperature-Controlled Consignments

16.1 Applicable ranges

Class	Validated range	Excursion threshold	Products
Frozen	– 25 to – 15 °C	Any reading above – 12 °C	Frozen food, certain vaccines
Chilled	2 to 8 °C	Any reading above 10 °C for over 30 minutes, cumulative 2 hours	Pharmaceutical cold chain, dairy
Cool	8 to 15 °C	Any reading above 18 °C for over 2 hours	Certain nutraceuticals
Controlled room temperature	15 to 25 °C	Any reading above 30 °C for over 4 hours	Most oral solid dosage forms

16.2 Receipt sequence

1. The reefer unit is confirmed running on arrival and the set point is photographed before the doors are opened.
2. The dock shelter is sealed against the vehicle body.
3. The data logger is retrieved and its report downloaded before unloading begins.
4. The Quality Inspector reviews the logger report against the threshold table above and records the outcome.
5. Unloading proceeds only where no excursion is recorded, or where the Head – Quality Assurance has authorised receipt into quarantine pending disposition.
6. Product is moved directly from dock to cold room. Staging in the ambient area is not permitted at any time.
7. The elapsed time from door opening to cold room placement is recorded and must not exceed 30 minutes.

16.3 Excursion handling

An excursion is recorded as discrepancy code D-07 and the affected stock is received into quarantine status irrespective of its apparent condition. Disposition is made only by the Head – Quality Assurance, on the basis of the logger data, the product's stability profile and the customer's written instruction. Product is never released to unrestricted status on visual inspection alone.

17. Hazardous and Restricted Goods

Hazardous goods are received only at facilities licensed for the relevant class and only at the docks identified in the facility's hazardous materials plan. The Material Safety Data Sheet is verified as current before unloading, and the storage compatibility matrix in NBL/SOP/HS/007 is applied before a bin is assigned.

Class	Description	Licensed facilities	Segregation requirement
3	Flammable liquids	BHW-02, HSR-01	Dedicated bunded store, minimum 8 m from Class 5
5.1	Oxidising substances	BHW-02	Dedicated store, no co-location with Class 3 or 4
8	Corrosive substances	BHW-02, HSR-01, GGN-02	Bunded store with acid-resistant flooring
9	Miscellaneous, including lithium batteries	All facilities	Fire-rated cage, state of charge below 30 per cent

Class	Description	Licensed facilities	Segregation requirement
Not classified but restricted	Aerosols, alcohol-based sanitiser	All facilities	Separate rack bay, no ignition source within 5 m

Where a consignment presents a hazard class for which the facility is not licensed, the vehicle is not unloaded. The Warehouse Manager informs the customer and the transporter, records discrepancy code D-12, and arranges for the vehicle to be turned away. Unloading an unlicensed class is a critical non-compliance and is reported to the Head – Quality Assurance the same day.

18. Damaged and Rejected Material

Damaged and rejected material is segregated in the quarantine cage within two hours of the disposition being recorded. Segregation is physical, not merely notional: rejected stock stored alongside unrestricted stock has repeatedly been the root cause of erroneous dispatch.

Step	Action	Owner	Timing
1	Apply reject label and move to quarantine cage	Material Handler	Within 2 hours of disposition
2	Photograph damage and attach to FleetLink exception record	Quality Inspector	Same shift
3	Notify consignor with quantity, batch and photographic evidence	Inbound Executive	Within 4 working hours
4	Obtain consignor instruction — return, destroy or scrap sale	Warehouse Manager	Within 3 working days
5	Execute instruction and post the stock movement	Inbound Executive	Within 2 working days of instruction
6	Close the exception record and file evidence	Supervisor – Inbound	On completion

Where no consignor instruction is received within thirty days, the stock is treated under the abandoned goods clause of the applicable master service agreement and the matter is referred to the commercial team. Storage charges continue to accrue against the customer for the period the stock occupies the quarantine cage.

19. Returns and Reverse Consignments

Returns are received through the returns dock and are never mixed with forward inbound flow. Every return is received into quarantine status by default, regardless of its apparent condition, and is graded before any disposition is made.

Grade	Criterion	Default disposition
A	Unopened, undamaged, residual shelf life within policy	Return to unrestricted stock
B	Opened outer, inner packs intact, shelf life within policy	Repack under customer instruction, then unrestricted
C	Damaged inner pack or shelf life below policy	Scrap or destruction
D	Contaminated, tampered or suspected counterfeit	Isolate, notify Head – QA same day

Grade D returns are treated as a potential product security event. The stock is isolated in a locked cage, photographed, and reported to the Head – Quality Assurance and the customer on the same day. It is not returned to stock under any circumstance.

20. Documentation and Record Retention

Record	Format	Custodian	Retention
Gate entry register	FleetLink and bound register	Security Officer	3 years
Unloading tally sheet	Paper, countersigned	Inbound Executive	3 years
Weighbridge slip	Printed	Security Officer	3 years
Goods receipt note	FleetLink	System	8 years
Quality inspection report	FleetLink	System	5 years
Discrepancy register	FleetLink and Annexure 2 form	Supervisor – Inbound	8 years
Temperature logger report	PDF attached in FleetLink	System	5 years
Putaway confirmation log	FleetLink	System	3 years
Deviation record	FleetLink	Manager – QA	8 years
Training record	FleetLink learning module	Human Resources	Employment plus 3 years
Calibration certificate	Paper and scan	Maintenance	Instrument life plus 3 years

Records are retained for eight years where they support a financial position that may be examined in a statutory audit or a customer claim, and for shorter periods where they are purely operational. Retention is measured from the end of the financial year in which the record was created.

21. Performance Indicators and Service Levels

Inbound performance is reviewed daily by the Warehouse Manager and monthly by the Head – Warehouse Operations. The indicators below are computed by FleetLink from transactional data and are not manually compiled.

Indicator	Definition	Target	Threshold for review
Dock to stock time	Hours from gate entry to putaway confirmation, 95th percentile	8 hours ambient, 6 hours cold chain	Above target on 3 consecutive days
Receipt accuracy	GRN lines with no subsequent adjustment, as a percentage of lines	99.7 per cent	Below 99.5 per cent in a month
Putaway accuracy	Pallets found in the confirmed bin on audit, as a percentage	99.9 per cent	Below 99.7 per cent in a month
Discrepancy closure	Discrepancies closed within target, as a percentage	95 per cent	Below 90 per cent in a month
ASN compliance	Consignments arriving with a valid ASN, as a percentage	98 per cent	Below 95 per cent in a month
Vehicle turnaround	Hours from gate entry to gate exit, mean	3.5 hours	Above 4 hours in a week
Detention incidence	Vehicles exceeding standard unloading time, as a percentage	Below 5 per cent	Above 8 per cent in a week
Putaway ageing	Pallets unconfirmed beyond 8 hours, as a percentage	Below 0.5 per cent	Above 1 per cent on any day
Cold chain compliance	Cold consignments with no excursion, as a percentage	100 per cent	Any excursion

Receipt accuracy is deliberately measured after the fact rather than at the point of receipt, because an error detected at receipt has been prevented rather than committed. The indicator counts only those errors that escaped the control described in Section 10.

22. Escalation Matrix

Situation	First escalation	Within	Second escalation	Within
Seal discrepancy	Supervisor – Inbound	15 minutes	Warehouse Manager	30 minutes
Cold chain excursion	Quality Inspector	Immediate	Head – QA	2 hours
Unlicensed hazard class	Supervisor – Inbound	Immediate	Warehouse Manager	30 minutes
Shortage above ■ 1 lakh	Warehouse Manager	2 hours	Head – Warehouse Operations	Same day
FleetLink unavailable	Supervisor – Inbound	15 minutes	IT service desk and Warehouse Manager	30 minutes
Weighbridge failure	Supervisor – Inbound	30 minutes	Maintenance	2 hours
Pest or contamination evidence	Quality Inspector	Immediate	Head – QA	Same day
Suspected theft or pilferage	Warehouse Manager	Immediate	Head – Warehouse Operations and Security	1 hour
Putaway ageing beyond 24 hours	Warehouse Manager	Same day	Head – Warehouse Operations	Next working day
Customer complaint on receipt	Warehouse Manager	4 hours	Head – Warehouse Operations	Same day

22.1 Business continuity when FleetLink is unavailable

Where FleetLink is unavailable for more than thirty minutes, inbound receiving continues on the manual fallback. Tally sheets are completed in duplicate, gate entries are numbered from the manual gate register using the prefix M, and putaway locations are recorded on the tally sheet. All manual transactions are entered into FleetLink within four hours of service restoration and are reconciled by the Supervisor – Inbound before the shift closes.

23. Training and Competency

No person performs an activity described in this procedure without a current competency record. Competency is assessed on first assignment, on any revision of this procedure that changes an activity, and annually thereafter.

Role	Training modules	Assessment	Revalidation
Material Handler	Induction, MHE operation, manual handling, this procedure	Practical observation plus written test	Annual
Inbound Executive	This procedure, FleetLink inbound module, discrepancy handling	Written test, 80 per cent pass mark	Annual
Quality Inspector	Sampling plans, this procedure, cold chain handling, product knowledge	Written test plus witnessed inspection	Annual
Security Officer	Gate procedure, seal verification, document sighting	Written test	Annual
Supervisor – Inbound	All of the above plus deviation management	Written test plus case assessment	Annual

Training records are held in the FleetLink learning module and are auditable. A person whose competency record has lapsed is withdrawn from the activity until reassessed. This is enforced by the system: FleetLink refuses transactions from a user whose competency record for the relevant module has expired.

24. Health, Safety and Environment

24.1 Mandatory controls

- Safety footwear and high-visibility clothing are worn at all times in the dock and staging areas.
- Cut-resistant gloves are worn when opening cartons with a blade.
- Vehicle keys are surrendered at the gate and returned only on release of the vehicle.
- Wheel chocks and dock locks are engaged before a vehicle is opened.
- Material handling equipment is operated only by a licensed operator holding a current competency record.
- Spill kits are available within ten metres of any dock receiving liquid cargo.
- Emergency exits and fire equipment are kept clear of staged stock at all times.
- Working at height to reach a rack face is performed only from an approved order picker or platform ladder, never from a pallet or racking beam.

24.2 Incident reporting

Every incident and near miss occurring during inbound activity is reported to the Supervisor – Inbound before the end of the shift and recorded in the safety module of FleetLink. Near misses are reported on the same basis as incidents; a near miss that is not reported removes the opportunity to prevent the incident it foreshadowed.

24.3 Environmental controls

Waste stream	Segregation	Disposal route
Corrugated carton and paper	Blue bin at each dock	Authorised recycler, monthly
Stretch wrap and plastic strapping	Yellow bin at each dock	Authorised recycler, monthly
Wooden pallet, broken	RTE yard, marked area	Repair or authorised recycler
Spill absorbent, contaminated	Red drum, hazmat store	Authorised hazardous waste handler
Damaged product, non-hazardous	Quarantine cage	Destruction under NBL/SOP/QA/019

25. Non-Compliance and Deviation Management

25.1 Classification

Class	Description	Examples	Authority to approve deviation
Critical	Departure that may result in unsafe product, financial loss above ₹ 5 lakh or statutory breach	GRN posted before inspection; unlicensed hazard class unloaded; cold chain product released without disposition	Head – Quality Assurance only
Major	Departure that compromises a control but does not immediately endanger product or people	Tally sheet not countersigned; discrepancy notified after 4 hours; blind bin confirmation	Warehouse Manager
Minor	Departure with no effect on product integrity or record accuracy	Late shift handover entry; pallet label affixed at incorrect height	Supervisor – Inbound

25.2 Recording and closure

Every deviation, whether planned or unplanned, is recorded in the deviation module of FleetLink within twenty-four hours. The record states what was done instead of the procedure, why, who authorised it, and what corrective action follows. A deviation without a corrective action is not closed.

Recurrence of the same major deviation three times within a quarter triggers a formal root cause analysis by the Manager – Process Excellence, and the outcome is considered at the next scheduled review of this procedure. Repeated deviation is treated as evidence that the procedure does not match operating reality, not merely as evidence of indiscipline.

26. Revision History

Rev	Date	Summary of change	Approved by
1	12 Aug 2018	First issue for Bhiwandi Unit I	R. Menon, COO
2	03 Mar 2019	Extended to Chakan and Gurugram; weighment section added	R. Menon, COO
3	22 Jul 2020	Cold chain section added following commissioning of the Bhiwandi cold room	R. Menon, COO
4	09 Nov 2021	Discrepancy codes restructured from 6 to 12 categories; photographic evidence made mandatory for five codes	V. Raghavan, COO
5	15 Jun 2023	Aligned to FleetLink v3.8; bin assignment logic and velocity bands documented; putaway ageing brackets introduced	V. Raghavan, COO
6	01 Apr 2025	Aligned to FleetLink v4.2; residual shelf life table added; hazardous class licensing table added; business continuity fallback documented; escalation matrix expanded to 10 situations	V. Raghavan, COO

Annexure 1 — Inbound Vehicle Checklist

Completed by the Inbound Executive jointly with the Material Handler before the vehicle is opened. Any item marked No requires a decision by the Supervisor – Inbound, recorded in the remarks column.

#	Check	Yes / No	Remarks
1	Vehicle registration matches the inbound plan		
2	Gate entry number allotted and written on the challan		
3	Seal number matches the lorry receipt		
4	Seal intact and free of tampering		
5	Engine switched off and keys surrendered		
6	Wheel chock and dock lock engaged		
7	Dock leveller engaged and secure		
8	Dock area clear and illumination adequate		
9	Dock shelter sealed (cold chain only)		
10	Reefer running and set point photographed (cold chain only)		
11	Data logger retrieved and report downloaded (cold chain only)		
12	MHE pre-use inspection completed		
13	Spill kit available within 10 m (liquid cargo only)		
14	Material safety data sheet current (hazardous cargo only)		
15	Facility licensed for the declared hazard class		
16	Handlers wearing required personal protective equipment		
17	Vehicle floor and body free of contamination or infestation		
18	No unmanifested cargo visible in the vehicle		

Annexure 2 — Discrepancy Register Format

Field	Entry
Discrepancy number	System generated, format DSC///
Date and time raised	Automatic
Gate entry number	From gate register
Consignor and customer code	From FleetLink customer master
Invoice number and date	From tax invoice
Discrepancy code	From the table in Section 14.1
SKU, batch and quantity affected	Per line
Value affected	Computed from the customer price master
Photographic evidence	Mandatory for D-05, D-07, D-08, D-11, D-12
Raised by	User identity, automatic
Consignor notified on	Date and time, must be within 4 working hours
Resolution owner	Per the table in Section 14.1
Agreed resolution	Free text, minimum 20 characters
Closure date	Must be within the target closure period
Corrective action reference	Deviation number where applicable

Annexure 3 — Sampling Plan Reference

Extracted from the general inspection level II single sampling plan. Where the customer master specifies a different acceptance quality limit, the corresponding column of the published standard is used and the deviation from the default is noted on the inspection report.

Lot size	Code letter	Sample	AQL 1.0 Ac / Re	AQL 2.5 Ac / Re	AQL 4.0 Ac / Re
2 – 8	A	2	0 / 1	0 / 1	0 / 1
9 – 15	B	3	0 / 1	0 / 1	0 / 1
16 – 25	C	5	0 / 1	0 / 1	1 / 2
26 – 50	D	8	0 / 1	1 / 2	1 / 2
51 – 90	E	13	0 / 1	1 / 2	2 / 3
91 – 150	F	20	0 / 1	1 / 2	3 / 4
151 – 280	G	32	1 / 2	2 / 3	5 / 6
281 – 500	H	50	1 / 2	3 / 4	7 / 8
501 – 1200	J	80	2 / 3	5 / 6	10 / 11
1201 – 3200	K	125	3 / 4	7 / 8	14 / 15
3201 – 10000	L	200	5 / 6	10 / 11	21 / 22

Annexure 4 — Bin Addressing Convention

Every storage location carries a unique address in the form Z-AA-LL-PP, read from left to right as zone, aisle, level and position. The address is printed on the rack face in characters not less than 25 millimetres high and is barcoded in Code 128.

Segment	Length	Range	Meaning
Z — zone	1 character	A to H	A fast-pick face, B to F reserve racking, G cold room, H hazmat
AA — aisle	2 digits	01 to 64	Aisle number, counted from the outbound dock
LL — level	2 digits	00 to 06	00 is the ground position; levels ascend
PP — position	2 digits	01 to 24	Pallet position along the aisle

Bin addresses are never reused for a different physical location. Where racking is reconfigured, retired addresses are closed in FleetLink and new addresses are issued from the next available sequence. This preserves the meaning of historical transaction records, which would otherwise refer to locations that no longer exist in the form described.

End of procedure NBL/SOP/WH/014 Revision 6. This document contains 26 sections and 4 annexures. Queries relating to interpretation are directed to the document owner, Head – Warehouse Operations (West).